

Metropolitan Grand Lodge
Members' Pathway
Personal Mentoring Guide

1. INTRODUCTION

The Members' Pathway has been developed to provide an overall framework to help Lodges to:

- Plan Lodge and Membership Development
- Attract and welcome new members
- Engage with new and existing members to reduce losses through resignations, cessations and exclusions
- Find ways to encourage those who have drifted away to re-kindle their interest and re-join.

The aim is to help all lodges become vibrant in which every meeting, including dining, is so enjoyable and worthwhile every member looks forward to the next meeting with an enthusiasm that is infectious.

Every lodge should ensure that each of its members enjoys his masonry, makes new friends and is encouraged to make a daily advancement in masonic knowledge. It is the role of the Lodge Mentor, assisted by other knowledgeable members of the lodge, to facilitate this aim by providing each member with the level of support, training and education that best suits his needs and aspirations.

The Metropolitan Mentoring Team offers workshops and webinars to train the would-be mentor in his important role. But more support may well be needed in performing the day-to-day activities of mentoring the members of his lodge in accordance with the Members' Pathway. To this end, the Metropolitan Mentoring Team has produced this Personal Mentoring Guide and accompanying Personal Mentoring Plan to help Lodge Mentors support, develop and educate the members of their lodge.

The Personal Development Plan is closely aligned with the Members' Pathway and is aimed primarily at the ENGAGE elements of the Members' Pathway. As such it provides detailed information about the mentee and his journey within masonry. The Plan can therefore be of great use when undertaking the RETRIEVE elements as a source of relevant information about the member.



The Plan and Guides are closely aligned with the Members' Pathway and consist of a series of information packs and activites that can be provided to each member at key points in his masonic journey aimed at helping him to understand his progress thus far:-

- The Welcome Pack
- Welcome Project (https://www.rosetta.london/the-welcome-project)
- Initiation: Information Pack and The Initiates Guide
- Passing: Information Pack and FC Personal Guide
- Raising: Information Pack and MM Personal Guide

The mentor is provided with a Personal Mentoring Plan template that can be adapted and personalised for each member and will allow the mentor to track and direct the member's development. It is also recommended that the mentee should also hold a copy of his Personal Mentoring Plan so that he is aware of what is to come and those areas where he may need additional mentoring.

This document is provided as a guide to assist the mentor in providing development and education to masons at all stages of their masonic journey. **This guide is not intended to be prescriptive and may be adapted by the mentor to suit the needs of his lodge and the aspirations of each member; every lodge is different and every member has different needs.**

The Personal Mentoring Plan

The Personal Mentoring Plan can be downloaded from the Mentor section in Rosetta and has a useful summary section where the mentor or mentee can record key events on the mentee's masonic journey. The remainder of the document is broken down into seven key stages which relate to logical masonic milestones as discussed at the Metropolitan Mentoring Workshops and Webinars and detailed in the Members' Pathway brochure:

(Personal Mentoring Plan).

Each key stage is presented in the form of a Development Guidance List which is cross referenced to further documentation where appropriate to provide additional explanation and information for the mentor. These lists are meant only for guidance and should be tailored as the mentor sees fit; you should be ready to adapt the framework to the needs of your lodge and its members and when you come across something that works don't be afraid to repeat it. Do not use the plan as a means of forcing the mentee to do things. He should always be made to feel comfortable with the activities detailed on the plan which should be regularly reviewed with the Lodge/Personal Mentor.

The 'Welcome Pack' and Development Guides

In support of the Personal Mentoring Plan, additional documentation is provided for the mentee in the form of a 'Welcome Pack' and additional 'Development Guides' (see Sections 2.1. to 2.4. below). It is suggested that these are formally presented by the Lodge Mentor to new members directly following the Ceremonies of Initiation, Passing and Raising. This public demonstration of the mentoring process in action is intended to reinforce the concept of mentoring for all brethren, to enhance the role of the Lodge Mentor in the eyes of all concerned and to elevate the importance of

the mentee himself. Lodge Mentors will receive appropriate training via Metropolitan Mentoring Workshops and Webinars in the application of this process.

Some mentors will no doubt wish to add items to these guidance lists, while others may feel that some of the elements are not appropriate for their mentee or lodge. Equally some may wish to devolve the responsibility for delivering some elements of the programme to appointed Personal Mentors. Making such judgments is perfectly acceptable. However, it is considered essential that the mentor is committed to making sure that **his** proposed programme is effective and seen through to its completion, as raising expectations which are subsequently not met will be counterproductive and result in potential disillusionment.

The Welcome Project

Every new Initiate and Exaltee in the Metropolitan area will have an early opportunity to attend and observe a high-quality Initiation/ Exaltation within a few short weeks after joining, chosen by them from a number of specially selected Lodge and Chapter meetings. They will meet other recent joiners to London Masonry and build new friendships whilst gaining an understanding of the ceremony they recently participated in.

The project is administered by coordinators responsible to each AMet. New members will receive by e-mail a letter from The Welcome Project detailing the range of meetings available via a dedicated website with easy-to-follow booking instructions.

Visiting Officers will also ring new members shortly after their joining ceremony and assist in arranging a suitable meeting to attend in company with a member of their own Lodge or Chapter.

The new members will be supported in the meeting itself and at dinner afterwards by the VO/SVO of that Lodge or Chapter, and usually a Metropolitan Grand Inspector will be present.

The 'Start-to Finish Guide' details the role Inspectors, Secretaries, Scribe's Ezra, Mentors and Proposers play along with the SVO/VO in ensuring that new members have the best experience and develop an immediate sense of belonging, not only to their own unit, but to the wider masonic community of Metropolitan Grand Lodge and Chapter.

Further details are available on Rosetta : https://www.rosetta.london/the-welcome-project

2. INFORMATION PACKS

2.1. The Welcome Pack

The new members' 'Welcome Pack' and the Initiation Information Pack are presented to a newly initiated brother immediately following the Ceremony of Initiation by the Lodge Mentor. 'The Initiate's Guide' is contained within the 'Initiation Information Pack' but is normally presented by the Visiting Officer if present.

The purpose of the 'Welcome Pack' is to facilitate a new member's general understanding of his lodge, the Craft in general and in particular its charitable works. Also to be included are documents and journals that will be of a more general interest. The exact contents will be determined by the lodge and Lodge Mentor and will be subject to those booklets/journals that are available at any particular point in time.

With the exception of 'The Initiate's Guide', the Metropolitan Mentoring Team will make available the core contents via "Rosetta" (https://www.rosetta.london/); this can be added to by the Lodge Mentor, as appropriate.

Typically, a new member's 'Welcome Pack' will consist of the following:

a. Relevant introductory material for a new member and his family / friends, e.g:

i. Copy of the Lodge Summons (Ceremony of Initiation)
ii. Lodge members name and address list – including wives & partners
iii. Lodge history
iv. 'Freemasonry – What's it All About ?
v. 'Freemasonry Cares'
vi. The Freemason's Grand Charity Annual Review
vii. Freemasonry in London – An Introduction to Membership
viii. UGLE Masonic Museum
ix. Metropolitan Masonic Charity – Annual Report and Accounts
x. RMBI – Our Services
xi. The Central Masonic Charities

b. Journals of interest

i. Complimentary copy of 'ARENA'
https://www.rosetta.london/publications/arena
ii. Complimentary copy of 'Freemasonry Today'
https://www.ugle.org.uk/about-freemasonry/freemasonry-today

2.2. Initiation: Information Pack and The Initiates Guide

Following the completion of the Initiation Confirmation Report by the Secretary and Visiting Officer, the new member will receive a Letter of Welcome and Congratulations from the Metropolitan Grand Inspector (MetGInsp) which will be posted directly to him after the meeting.

The 'Initiation Information Pack' is presented to the new member (mentee) at the meeting and should contain:

a) A copy of the Metropolitan Grand Lodge's booklet 'The Initiate's Guide' which is usually presented by the Visiting Officer to the candidate immediately after his Initiation Ceremony; the contents of which include:

Freemasonry – A Brief History
Lodge Officers
Layout of a Lodge Room
Symbolic Explanation of the Ceremony of Initiation
Charge After Initiation
Concerning God and Religion
Of the Civil Magistrate, Supreme and Subordinate
Ritual
Basic Masonic Etiquette
Festive Board
Inviting Guests
Visiting other Lodges
Second Degree Questions and Answers
Hymns Which May be Sung at Opening and Closing of Lodge

A copy of 'The Initiate's Guide' can be obtained from the Metropolitan Grand Lodge Office in Freemasons Hall. It is also available electronically via "Rosetta" (https://www.rosetta.london/Download.ashx?assetid=364).

b) A copy of the Metropolitan Mentoring Team's booklet 'Initiates Personal Guide CP 1', the contents of which include more detailed coverage of:

i. A Brief History
ii. Symbolic Explanation of the Ceremony of Initiation
iii. What Happened at your Initiation
iv. Symbolism
v. Charge After Initiation
vi. Concerning GOD and RELIGION
vii. Of the CIVIL MAGISTRATE, SUPREME and SUBORDINATE
viii. Layout of the Lodge Room
ix. Lodge Officers
x. Hymns which may be sung
xi. Masonic Clothing
xii. Masonic Etiquette
xiii. The Festive Board
xiv. Inviting Guests
xv. Visiting other Lodges
xvi. Charity is at the heart of Freemasonry
xvii. Second Degree Questions and Answers (Abbreviated)

The Initiate should also be made aware of the MetGL Welcome Project and be invited to attend one of the Welcome Meetings as soon as possible after his Initiation.

2.3. Passing: Information Pack and FC Personal Guide

The 'Passing Information Pack' presented to the mentee contains:

- A copy of 'The Fellowcraft's Guide' which is available electronically via "Rosetta" https://www.rosetta.london/Download.ashx?assetid=368

- A copy of the Metropolitan Mentoring Team's booklet 'FC Personal Guide CP 2', the contents of which include:
  i. What is a Fellow Craft?
  ii. Symbolic Explanation of the Ceremony of Passing
  iii. Tracing Board
  iv. Working Tools (2nd. Degree)
  v. Symbolism
  vi. Charity is at the heart of Freemasonry
  vii. Relationship between UGLE and the Provinces
  viii. Masonic Clothing
  ix. Third Degree Questions and Answers

2.4. Raising: Information Pack and MM Personal Guide

The 'Raising Information Pack' is presented to the mentee in an A5 plastic wallet containing:

- A copy of 'The Master Mason's Guide' which is available electronically via "Rosetta" https://www.rosetta.london/Download.ashx?assetid=369

- A copy of the Metropolitan Mentoring Team's booklet 'MM Personal Guide CP 3', the contents of which include:
  i. Symbolic Explanation of the Ceremony of Raising
  ii. Applying the Principles to our Everyday Lives
  iii. Life as a Master Mason
  iv. Lodge of Instruction
  v. Grand Lodge Certificate
  vi. Visiting other Lodges
  vii. Conclusion – Being a Mason in the World
  viii. Talking about Freemasonry
  ix. Relationship between the Craft and the Holy Royal Arch
  x. Metropolitan Grand Chapter Leaflet
  https://www.rosetta.london/Download.ashx?Assetid=276

3. CONCLUSION

The Metropolitan Mentoring Team hope that you will find this guide, plan and supporting information helpful in running the Mentoring activities within your Lodge in accordance with the Members' Pathway. The Team are always willing to answer your questions, to help you resolve issues and to listen to your suggestions.

Please check out our pages on Rosetta (https://www.rosetta.london/mentor) or contact us on metmentor@metmentor.com.

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